admitting mistakes. In England Mr. Lloyd George has come out with his 'New Deal'. We want many New Deals in India too. The old assumption that "whatever is worth knowing is already known, and whatever is worth doing has already been done," is perilous nonsense.

We have to face many questions, and we must face them boldly. Has the present social or economic system a right to exist if it is unable to improve greatly the condition of the masses? Does any other system give promise of this widespread betterment? How far will a mere political change bring radical improvement? If vested interests come in the way of an eminently desirable change, is it wise or moral to attempt to preserve them at the cost of mass misery and poverty? Surely the object is not to injure vested interests, but to prevent them from injuring others. If it was possible to come to terms with these vested interests, it would be most desirable to do so. People may disagree with the justice or injustice of this, but few will doubt the expediency of a settlement. Such a settlement obviously cannot be the removal of one vested interest by the creation of another. Whenever possible and desirable, reasonable compensation might be given, for a conflict is likely to cost far more. But, unhappily, all history shows that vested interests do not accept such compromises. Classes that have ceased to play a vital part in society are singularly lacking in wisdom. They gamble for all or nothing, and so they fade away.

There is a great deal of 'loose talk' (as the Congress Working Committee put it) about confiscation and the like. Confiscation, persistent and continual, is the basis of the existing system, and it is to put an end to this that social changes are proposed. There is the daily confiscation of part of the labour product of the worker; a peasant's holding is ultimately confiscated by raising his rent or revenue to such an extent that he cannot pay it. Formerly common lands were confiscated by individuals and made into big estates; peasant proprietors were also wiped out in this way. Confiscation is the basis and life-breath of the present system.

To remedy this partly, society tries various expedients which are themselves of the nature of confiscation—heavy taxes, death-duties, laws for the relief from indebtedness, inflation, etc. Recently we have seen national repudiation of debt on an enormous scale, not only by the Soviet Union but by leading capitalist countries; the most notable instance of this being the British repudiation of their debt to the United States—a